

The film's first scene found Tony Stark amid the violence and chaos of the Afghanistan desert. However, the film then transitioned back in time, 36 hours before the weapons designer had his chest violently split open by his own handiwork, to the opulent grandeur of an awards ceremony at a Caesars Palace ballroom in Las Vegas (above, right). Of course, as is typical in moviemaking, the actual set was in Los Angeles. Production Designer MICHAEL RIVA had his hands full getting the job done.

RIVA: "Believe it or not, *Iron Man* had a very restricted budget. We had to make certain decisions about going to Vegas or not for the awards sequence. I would have preferred to go, but our mandate was to use L.A. I thought that with a few additional statues and some lavish ornamentation, we could make the ballroom of a local hotel look like Caesars."

